

AI for Impact

Learning Expedition – Boston

A hands-on AI innovation experience where students learn to design, prototype, and position AI-driven solutions in real-world contexts.

During this project, students will work on real-world challenges and develop solutions that combine:

Business Strategy

AI Capabilities

Practical Experimentation

The objective is to move beyond ideas and build credible, impactful, and realistic solutions aligned with today's innovation and startup environments.

Project Objectives & Skills

Objectives

- Identify a real and complex problem in a high-impact sector
- Design an AI-powered solution that addresses this problem
- Demonstrate both business value and feasibility
- Develop a solution aligned with startup and innovation standards

Skills Developed

Market Research & Analysis

- Identify key trends and opportunities
- Analyze existing solutions
- Understand why the problem persists

Business Strategy & Innovation

- Build a clear and relevant business model
- Define a go-to-market strategy
- Develop a growth and scaling vision

AI & Product Thinking

- Understand how AI can be applied to real problems

Communication & Pitch

- Present a structured and compelling solution

- Design AI-driven solutions
- Experiment with tools through prototyping (vibecoding)

- Defend choices and assumptions
- Deliver an investor-style pitch

Project Topics (Themes)

Each team must choose one of the following themes:

- AI for Media & Content Creation
- Retail & Shopping Experience
- Education & Workforce Development
- Non-Profit & Social Good
- Sustainability & Green Innovation
- Healthcare & Well-being
- Startup & Venture Growth
- AI for Community Engagement & Social Inclusion

Note

Teams must justify their choice using market trends and real opportunities.

Key Steps of the Project

1

Problem & Opportunity

- Define a real-world problem
- Identify users and stakeholders
- Analyze the market and existing solutions

Key question: *Why has this problem not been effectively solved yet?*

2

AI Solution Design

- Describe the proposed solution
- Define key features and user experience
- Explain the role of AI

Key question: *Why is AI necessary for this solution (and not just an add-on)?*

3

Project Development

Business Students

- Market analysis
- Business model (value creation & monetization)
- Prototype or experimentation (vibecoding)
- Go-to-market strategy
- Growth strategy

Tech Students

- AI solution logic (inputs / outputs)
- Tool selection (APIs, no-code, AI tools)
- Prototype or experimentation (vibecoding)
- Feasibility analysis

4

Strategic Analysis

- Identify key risks (market, technical, adoption)
- Define limitations of the solution
- Explain key decisions and trade-offs

5

Final Pitch

- Present a clear and structured solution
- Demonstrate the concept or prototype
- Highlight business value and impact

Important

Even though teams focus on different aspects, all students must understand the business value of the solution and the AI logic and capabilities behind it.

Deliverables

Final Report

10-15 pages

- Problem analysis
- Solution design
- Development

Prototype

Visual or functional

- Business: visual (mandatory), functional (optional)
- Tech: functional prototype or experiment

Final Pitch

10 minutes

- Structured presentation
- Demo (if applicable)
- Q&A

Evaluation Criteria

Shared Criteria

- Relevance and depth of the problem
- Quality and originality of the solution

- Justification of AI use
- Clarity and structure

Business Evaluation

- Market understanding
- Strength of business model
- Strategic thinking

Tech Evaluation

- Logic of the AI solution
- Quality of prototype / experimentation
- Feasibility and realism

Bonus Points

- Functional prototype (for business teams)
- Strong execution and clarity
- Clear link between business and tech

Learning Approach

This project follows a hands-on approach:

Design

Identify a real problem and
define an AI solution

Prototype

Experiment with AI tools
(vibecoding)

Position

Build a strong business case
and strategy

Final Note

*The goal is not only to create an idea, but to design a solution that is credible, impactful,
and feasible in the real world.*